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#HATTAWINTER CAMPAIGN LAUNCHED

6 festivals to be held as part of #HattaWinter that attracted 1m visitors last year

30 small businesses from the Proudly from Dubai initiative will participate

50 Emirati bee-keepers will take part in the Hatta Honey Festival



Dubai Media Office

Brand Dubai, the creative arm of the Government of Dubai Media Office, yesterday announced the launch of the second edition of #HattaWinter. Part of the #DubaiDestinations campaign, #HattaWinter will run from December 5 to January 31, 2026. **SEE ALSO P6**

DXB gears up for record year-end with 10m flyers

TRAVEL ADVISORY URGES PASSENGERS TO PLAN AHEAD

DUBAI
BY DHANUSHA GOKULAN
Chief Reporter

Dubai Airports, the operator of the world's busiest hub Dubai International (DXB) and Dubai World Central (DWC), has issued a travel advisory urging passengers to plan ahead as DXB gears up for a record-breaking year-end travel wave.

A whopping 10 million passengers are expected to pass through the airport between November 27 and December 31.

Airport authorities said the surge will begin with the UAE National Day long weekend, when daily passenger numbers are projected to exceed 294,000, before climbing to over 300,000 in December.

303,000 travellers in a day

Saturday, December 20, is forecast to be the busiest day with 303,000 travellers.

Paul Griffiths, CEO of Dubai Airports, called the movement "a powerful indicator of Dubai's global appeal." He said DXB's operations were "well-prepared to deliver a world-class experience during this excit-

TIPS FROM DUBAI AIRPORTS

- Arrive no later than three hours before departure.
- Use online check-in whenever possible.
- Use Smart Gates for speedy passport control (for travellers aged 12 and above).
- First and Business Class Emirates customers at Terminal 3 can use the 'Red Carpet' Smart Tunnel for document-free passport checks.
- Use the Dubai Metro to access Terminals 1 and 3, as operating hours are extended during peak times.
- Make use of facilities for People of Determination, including marked accessibility routes and dedicated lounges.



DXB: FROM 1960 TO NOW IN FOCUS, P10-11

ing and busy festive season." December is expected to mark DXB's busiest month on record, with over 8.7 million travellers forecast. The pattern of travel will mirror past years, with outbound journeys peaking before the National Day weekend

as residents take short breaks, followed by a strong rise in inbound arrivals in mid-December driven by Dubai's festive attractions.

Dubai Airports has placed emphasis on smart travel technologies and real-time information for passengers. Enhanced coordination with Emirates will allow travellers to use options such as home, early and self-service check-in, and city check-in facilities at ICD Brookfield Place in DIFC. Airport officials also reminded travellers to stay updated via DXB Express Maps and mobile alerts for gate and flight information.

NATION

UAE National Day weekend: Your guide to fireworks across the Emirates | P4

BUSINESS

Find out what drives Britons to the UAE apart from tax relief and sunshine | P-1

SPECIAL REPORT

Leaders who are changing the rules



BUSINESS

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SPORT

Norris' moment of reckoning in Qatar as F1 title race goes down to the wire | P15

Death toll in Hong Kong fire rises to 65

Over 250 people still missing after worst fire in almost 80 years

HONG KONG

Hong Kong authorities said yesterday the death toll from the city's worst fire in decades had risen to 65, as firefighters scoured scorched high-rise buildings in an apartment complex for more than 250 people listed as missing.

Flames were still visible in some of the eight-building

housing estate's almost 2,000 units well over 24 hours after the fire broke out, with crews still spraying water over the blackened exteriors.

Authorities have begun investigating what sparked the disastrous blaze — the financial hub's worst in almost 80 years — including the presence of bamboo scaffolding and plastic mesh wrapped around the structures as part of an estate-wide renovation. Hong Kong's anti-corruption body said it has launched a probe into renovation work at the housing com-

plex, hours after police said they had arrested three men on suspicion of negligently leaving foam packaging at the fire site.

Residents of Wang Fuk Court, located in Hong Kong's northern district of Tai Po, told AFP that they did not hear any fire alarms and had to go door-to-door to alert neighbours to the danger. Of the 65 people confirmed dead by 8pm local time (1200 GMT) yesterday, one was a 37-year-old firefighter and two were Indonesians working as migrant domestic workers.

— AFP

SEE ALSO P13



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